



MONTHLY UPDATE

Liberia: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-09 · 22 systems and instruments tracked, 9 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-09 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

July 2026 was organised around the Liberia Technology Summit of 21-22 July, at which the President made the whole-of-government digital office the centre of the agenda and the telecoms ministry named four builds — a national digital addressing system, a second subsea cable, expanded fibre and a national data centre — none of them dated or costed. In the same weeks the telecoms regulator revoked an operator's licence, refused to publish its own revenue and became the subject of a corruption complaint; the African Development Bank launched a six-year country strategy with no digital sector in it; and the first figures were published for the e-procurement platform and the interoperable payment fee schedule.

Infrastructure

The regulator revoked [Starcell International Liberia's universal licence and spectrum authorisation with immediate effect on 22 July 2026](#), after a 90-day suspension from 9 February during which no corrective action was taken; spectrum, numbering resources and regulatory privileges revert to the Authority. The grounds cited were failure to commence operations, unmet financial obligations and non-payment of universal access contributions.

The same package, [set out on 17 July](#), covers a split of infrastructure and service licences with rural incentives, tower-sharing rules, the country's first satellite regulations, an IMEI anti-theft regime and repatriation of the .lr country domain. None has been published as an instrument.

Speaking on 21 July, the Posts and Telecommunications Minister said rollout of a national digital postal address system had [begun across all fifteen counties, and announced a second subsea cable, expanded fibre and a national data centre to hold government data domestically](#). No completion date, budget line, cable landing partner or data-centre site was given for any of them; the LTA separately said it is reviewing a World Bank-supported report on reducing telecom costs.

On 30 July the Anti-Corruption Commission [confirmed it had forwarded a complaint about the telecoms traffic-monitoring arrangement to its investigation unit](#). No evidence has been publicly produced and no findings made.

Digital public infrastructure

The e-procurement platform published its first operating figures on 5 August: [more than 1,200 vendors registered and more than US\\$400,000 in revenue generated](#). No contract value transacted, tender count, bidder numbers or share of government procurement passing through the platform is given. Two days later it became an export: Sierra Leone's procurement authority [sent a delegation to Monrovia on 6-7 August to study the implementation](#), where the executive director dated the national launch to February 2025 after a six-institution pilot and credited the African Development Bank and the World Bank with the backing behind it.

The central bank's fee schedule for interoperable transfers was reported on 5 August: [1.0% of value from US\\$1.00 to US\\$2,000.00 and a flat US\\$25.00 above that, available 24 hours a day](#). The flat cap falls below 1.0% of value above about US\$2,500 and keeps falling.

On 28 July the finance minister named the [national electronic payment switch as the enabler of a 24-hour economy, with creative-sector support to enter the 2027 budget](#). No go-live date was given.

Governance and regulation

The African Development Bank launched its [country strategy for 2026-2031 in Monrovia on 30 July, cutting its sectors from four to three and funding an indicative 2026-2028 programme of UA 129m – US\\$172.86m at the February 2026 conversion – of which 36.3% is unfunded](#). The only digital line in the indicative programme is a non-lending study on digital solutions for Monrovia traffic congestion, and the strategy's own ICT assessment cites a policy that expired in 2024.

The telecoms regulator's chairman declined at a 30 July press briefing to disclose the Authority's revenue, [saying he reports to the President](#). The Authority publishes industry data – its 2025 mid-year report puts the two operators' combined revenue at US\$96.1m for the first half of 2025 against US\$79.8m a year earlier – but its own licensing fees, spectrum charges, levies and numbering receipts remain unpublished as at 4 August 2026.

At the African Telecommunications Union plenipotentiary session in Abuja in July, Liberia [negotiated a waiver of US\\$361,151.36 in arrears dating back to 1982, deposited its instrument of ratification and had its voting rights restored](#).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

At the President's third national youth town hall in Buchanan on 29 July, the President's Youth Advisory Council called for artificial intelligence to be made a national priority through education frameworks, innovation and fabrication laboratories and skills provision. The President [did not dismiss it and conditioned support on applications in agriculture, transport and commerce; no policy, institution, budget line or date followed](#).

The country's first working legal AI was launched on 31 July: [CJ Lewis, built by the law library Liblaw over Supreme Court opinions from 1861 to 2026 plus statutes and regulations, with OHCHR support on human-rights principles in the design](#). No accuracy or evaluation figure is given, no model or vendor is named, and the corpus is a private compilation.

The technology summit closed on 22 July with [a Monrovia cybersecurity firm winning the national Startup World Cup on a domestic-data-custody pitch](#), and the port authority signed a [non-exclusive smart-ports memorandum with HAROPA PORT covering all four seaports, with no amount, date or named system](#).

Inclusion, capacity and finance

UNDP set out its contributions at the summit and added two specifics in its own account of 3 August: the innovation hub sits under its Africa innovation platform, and it has [announced a partnership with the University of Liberia to establish the country's first master's degree in artificial intelligence](#). No commitment amount was disclosed for any of it.

On 31 July, 19 young leaders took the [first of three media and information literacy sessions in Monrovia, run through the UN electoral support project with the National Elections Commission and the Press Union on Canadian funding](#). Six external funders and implementers stand behind a programme whose stated purpose is national resilience against misinformation before elections, and no budget figure is disclosed for it.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-09
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/LBR/LBR-monthly-2026-07.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/reports/LBR/LBR-monthly-2026-07-2026-08-09.pdf
DERIVED FROM	Data Landscapers source base, commit <code>ea6e045ec0be</code>
VERIFY	Hash this file and look it up in https://corpus.data-landscapers.com/manifest.csv
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